

Jessica Alba Dynasty League – 2021 Rookie Draft Preview

I. Introduction

We made it through the inaugural season with our worthy winner Ross taking the belt. We've all now taken the chance to review our teams and cut our rosters down to 25. With the NFL Draft in two weeks and our draft in a month I thought it would be helpful to do a little review of all the teams. Is your team as good/bad as you think? Where might people need to draft some young blood to improve their team. Will you need to trade up to get your man? Does the draft matter at all and can you trade actual players to improve your team?

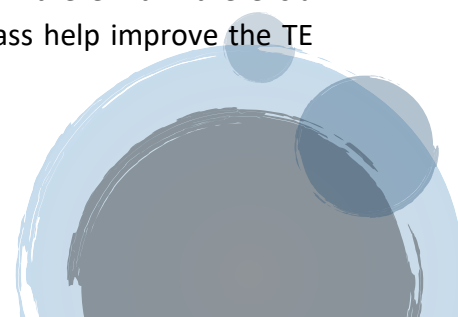
All these questions will not get answered and there will only be numerous other questions like: is our Commissioner deluded? Is Chris' team any good? Why is Gareth's team so old? Does Dave even need a QB? One thing that is for sure – most of us need to update the highly unimaginative team names.

II. 2021 Draft

So the draft board (as things stand) is in the table below:

Round 1	Round 2	Round 3	Round 4	Round 5
1. Dave	1. Dave	1. Dave	1. Dave	1. Dave
2. Rich	2. Rich	2. Rich	2. Rich	2. Rich
3. Mike	3. Mike	3. Mike	3. Mike	3. Mike
4. Neil	4. Neil	4. Neil	4. Neil	4. Neil
5. Lee	5. Alex (from Lee)	5. Lee	5. Lee	5. Lee
6. Lee (from Chris)	6. Lee (from Chris)	6. Chris	6. Chris	6. Chris
7. Lee (from Jebus)	7. Dave (from Jebus)	7. Lee (from Jebus)	7. Jebus	7. Jebus
8. Alex	8. Lee (from Alex)	8. Ross (from Alex)	8. Alex	8. Alex
9. Gareth	9. Gareth	9. Gareth	9. Gareth	9. Gareth
10. Ross	10. Ross	10. Ross	10. Ross	10. Ross

Dave is looking to take Trevor Lawrence at the 1.01 but after that will things become murky. There's a lot of QB needy teams and what appears to be an outstanding intake of rookie QBs. There's also a strong WR class, including players who outshone last season's breakout rookie, Justin Jefferson. RBs look a little more tricky with three standout prospects and potentially a bit of a drop-off from there. At TE there is a unicorn apparently. He does actually appear to be a man though. Will this class help improve the TE landscape or are we just adding a bit more dearth?



Jessica Alba Dynasty League – 2021 Season Rookie Draft Preview

One thing clear right now is our draft will be dominated by one man(ish) manager – Lee Anthony Colwill. With 9 picks, including 5 in the first two rounds, he holds some keys to how the draft will fall. Unless he trades it all for newlywed, Trevor Lawrence???

Before I analyse each team I thought I'd caveat the data. It's using the highly useful but not infallible KeepTradeCut. Value ≠ Production but this is dynasty and maybe long-term production is linked to value. I don't know but I look forward to finding out!

III. Pick #1 – Baby Chark doo doo doo – Dave

Total						Starters		Draft Capital			
Ave Age	Rank	Value	Rank	Value (No DC)	Rank	Value	Rank	Value	Rank		
26.2	7	112,832	2	94,992	2	48,217	8	17,840	2		
QB						RB					
No.	Ave age	Value	Rank	Value PP	Rank PP	No.	Ave age	Value	Rank	Value PP	Rank PP
4	28.43	22,311	2	5,578	2	8	25.21	33,734	1	4,217	3
WR						TE					
No.	Ave age	Value	Rank	Value PP	Rank PP	No.	Ave age	Value	Rank	Value PP	Rank PP
8	24.68	29,512	7	3,689	7	3	25.58	9,435	4	3,145	4

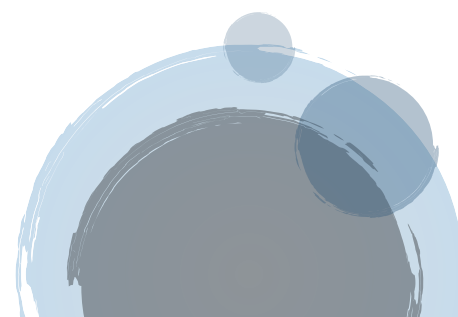
First things first, it's not a great team name but it's more imaginative than his username! Anyhoo, onto the team. Dave's number one pick which can move straight into his team comes at a good time. He has an aging team and has one of the oldest QB cores. However, he has got the second best QB group and value per player so the question is: Does he actually need to be picking a QB? Is there an opportunity to 'do a Miami' and trade down to secure his long-term future?

Dave's overall team ranking of 2 (with and without his number 2 draft capital) he must be feeling pretty confident moving into year two. However, a starter ranking of 8 suggests he's missing those studs to push him over the line. With all that draft capital can he make some moves to put him in a position to win the championship?

Dave has the best RB core and third best per player value. However, they are aging so is a new influx waiting in the wings just what Dave needs?

WR looks like the most needy part of his team. He's added youth (and a potential Lawrence stack) with his acquisition of DJ Chark but at 7 and 7 in core and per player ranking surely this will be the focus of Dave's draft?

TE is a difficult position to crack. There are three standout players so at fourth in core and per player rank, Dave is the best of the rest. He has the 1.01 and there's a unicorn waiting to be picked. Surely Pitts won't drop to 2.01?



IV. Pick #2 – Team Dudders79 – Rich

Total						Starters		Draft Capital			
Ave Age	Rank	Value	Rank	Value (No DC)	Rank	Value	Rank	Value	Rank		
27.32	9	92,529	8	77,984	9	48,728	6	14,545	3		
QB						RB					
No.	Ave age	Value	Rank	Value PP	Rank PP	No.	Ave age	Value	Rank	Value PP	Rank PP
4	35.57	13,715	9	3,429	9	7	23.97	24,549	3	3,507	6
WR						TE					
No.	Ave age	Value	Rank	Value PP	Rank PP	No.	Ave age	Value	Rank	Value PP	Rank PP
8	26.41	34,542	5	4,318	4	3	28.18	5,178	10	1,726	10

The first of the username teams. Surely we can do better!? Moving swiftly on, Rich's number two picks also come at a great time. An aging team in almost all areas needs a solid injection of youth.

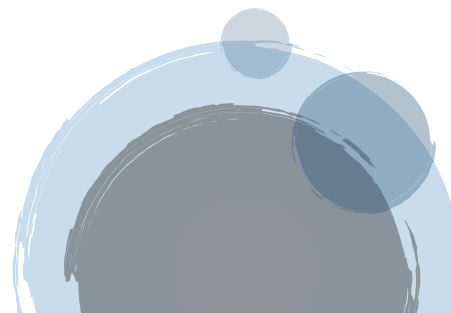
Rich's overall team ranking of 8, moving down to 9 without his draft capital, there must be some concerns about the viability of the team. An improved starter ranking of 6 suggests there is some hope if he can convert that draft capital into starting talent.

With the No2 pick he's got to be thinking of taking the first overall pick after Trevor. He's got the second worst QB core and value per player. Also an *average* QB age of over 35 is a bit eye watering!

Rich has a fairly young and extensive RB core – giving third overall value. With so many it is probably no surprise that per player he ranked 6th overall. A second-round investment in more RB cover here? Probably not when we look at the rest of the roster.

WR looks like an area where Rich may seek some long-term improvement. His aging core has low dynasty value but high production with the likes of Devante Adams. This probably means he may be able to wait until 2022 to improve this area of his team.

Rich is dead last in TE core and per player ranks. Surely a bid for Pitts or another TE is needed?



V. Pick #3 – Tompa Bay Bucs – Mike

Total						Starters		Draft Capital			
Ave Age	Rank	Value	Rank	Value (No DC)	Rank	Value	Rank	Value	Rank		
24.15	1	96,859	4	82,314	6	56,801	2	14,545	3		
QB						RB					
No.	Ave age	Value	Rank	Value PP	Rank PP	No.	Ave age	Value	Rank	Value PP	Rank PP
5	24.58	26,922	1	5,384	4	5	22.25	19,019	9	3,804	5
WR						TE					
No.	Ave age	Value	Rank	Value PP	Rank PP	No.	Ave age	Value	Rank	Value PP	Rank PP
8	25.65	28,227	8	3,528	9	3	24.11	8,146	7	2,715	7

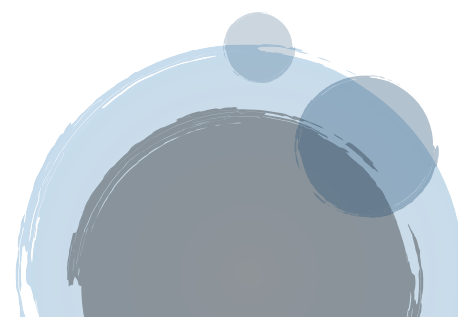
Mike's very youthful team has no particular need for the addition of any youth yet here he sits in a comfortable position. Even more so for his young and top ranking QB core. Just like Dave, can Tompa mimic it's neighbours in Miami and trade down for future certainty or some top quality WRs?

Mike's overall team ranking of 4 (6 without draft capital) and third best draft capital must have him feeling fairly confident going into 2021. A starter rank of 2 suggests he's close to having a real crack at the championship. The data suggests a slightly different story....

Mike's young but low value RB core must be his biggest concern. He doesn't need a QB but surely Najee will be available to scoop up at 1.03? Perhaps he has more confidence in his RBs than the hive mind of KTC but he could be one RB injury away from another season without even a playoff run.

WR looks like an area where Mike may seek some improvement. His older, low dynasty value, core has high production upside. Could he too wait until 2022 to improve this area of his team?

Mike's TE core and per player ranks at 7 a piece. Whilst they are young and could improve (with Goff??) the temptation to draft Pitts at 3 must be there.



VI. Pick #4 – Team NeilMWelsh – Neil

Total						Starters		Draft Capital			
Ave Age	Rank	Value	Rank	Value (No DC)	Rank	Value	Rank	Value	Rank		
25.77	5	69,958	10	57,216	10	36,528	10	12,742	5		
QB						RB					
No.	Ave age	Value	Rank	Value PP	Rank PP	No.	Ave age	Value	Rank	Value PP	Rank PP
3	26.94	6,086	10	2,029	10	9	25.78	18,585	10	2,065	10
WR						TE					
No.	Ave age	Value	Rank	Value PP	Rank PP	No.	Ave age	Value	Rank	Value PP	Rank PP
7	25.08	26,881	9	3,840	6	2	26.58	5,664	9	2,832	6

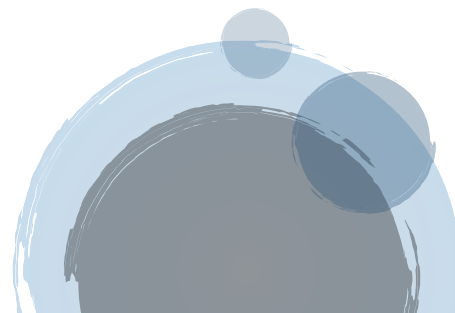
I thought this was going to be difficult until I noticed the team name. Instead, it's going to be both barrels! No, I still can't bring myself to do it.

Overall, Neil's team ranks dead last in everything but draft capital. Trading of picks to Lee has secured a relative drop even there. Maybe Neil needs to take a leaf out of Lee's book, enter a rebuild and scoop up future draft capital to make us all pay in 2023. We will all need to do it sooner or later, perhaps now is Neil's sooner?

Perhaps the rebuild can start at 1.04 and picking up a much-needed young QB? Ranking dead last (at time of writing – Deshaun Watson isn't in prison yet) in QB ranking and a draft class blessed with numerous QB talent, Neil has an immediate opportunity to improve.

Even with 9 RBs, Neil's RB core is also ranked last overall. Kamara aside, some serious investment is required.

At WR and TE a similar pattern emerges. Ranked 9th in core and 6th per player, sound investment, trading and a great deal of luck will be needed to compete in 2021.



VII. Picks #5, # 6 and #7 – Buffalo Bill Oddie – Lee

Total						Starters		Draft Capital			
Ave Age	Rank	Value	Rank	Value (No DC)	Rank	Value	Rank	Value	Rank		
25.92	6	116,045	1	86,905	4	48,598	7	29,140	1		
QB						RB					
No.	Ave age	Value	Rank	Value PP	Rank PP	No.	Ave age	Value	Rank	Value PP	Rank PP
3	27.44	14,036	8	4,679	7	7	23.86	21,047	7	3,007	8
WR						TE					
No.	Ave age	Value	Rank	Value PP	Rank PP	No.	Ave age	Value	Rank	Value PP	Rank PP
8	23.99	37,517	2	4,690	2	3	30.39	14,305	1	4,768	2

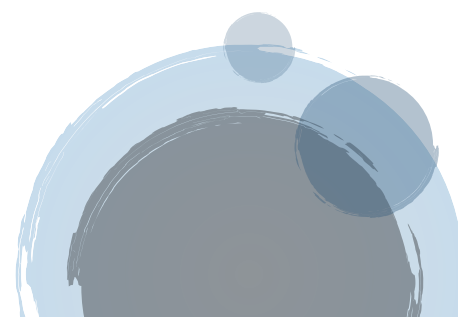
Lee's three first round picks have put him in a position to influence how the draft falls. However, his (entirely sensible) trade of Deshaun Watson has put him in a difficult position as he is outside the four potential QB starters. Does he take advantage of the capital and trade up or gamble that 3 starting QBs is enough?

Lee's overall team ranking of 1 is bolstered by a staggering amount of draft capital. Removing that his present team ranks at 4. Does his seemingly early rebuild by accumulating draft capital mean he is well placed to compete this year? Probably not. A starting ranking of 7, the normal slow start to rookies and oh my god those RBs(!) would suggest he is on track to compete in 2022. Maybe he'll surprise us with more dramatic trading to compete now?

Lee's young and extensive RB core is frankly built on hopes and dreams. Ranked 7th overall and 8th per player would suggest to me that those first round picks are going on some talented RBs. I mean, what else could you spend them on?

WR looks like an area where Lee can just relax, smugly knowing he's got the youngest and second ranked, overall and per player, core. Will he be able to resist adding another young WR? He should but this man is not always rational.

TE will be an interesting one. Lee's core and per player ranks put him at 1 and 2, respectively. Having Kelce and young back-ups to replace him should be enough but when a unicorn is sitting there on the board – how can you resist?



VIII. Pick #8 – Team alnewbs – Alex

Total						Starters		Draft Capital			
Ave Age	Rank	Value	Rank	Value (No DC)	Rank	Value	Rank	Value	Rank		
25.74	4	106,454	3	96,856	1	55,028	3	9,598	8		
QB						RB					
No.	Ave age	Value	Rank	Value PP	Rank PP	No.	Ave age	Value	Rank	Value PP	Rank PP
4	26.61	19,310	6	4,828	6	8	24.36	32,063	2	4,008	4
WR						TE					
No.	Ave age	Value	Rank	Value PP	Rank PP	No.	Ave age	Value	Rank	Value PP	Rank PP
9	26.09	36,384	3	4,043	5	2	27.48	9,099	6	4,550	3

Yet another username team. Last I heard the man isn't even working. Maybe some small part of his day could be spent dreaming up a team name? In any case, Alex is the sixth player to pick off the board and appears to have a team that just needs a little push to win a championship.

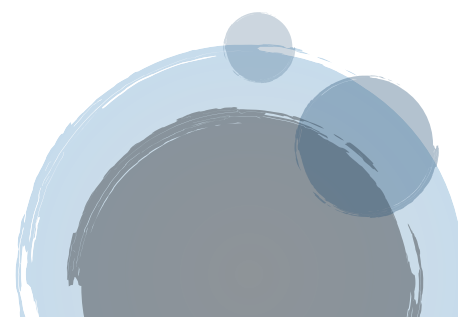
Alex's overall team ranking of 3, moving up to 1 without his draft capital, and a starter ranking of 3 suggests he could be in a position to compete. But what does the data tell us on a positional basis?

It's highly unlikely one of the QBs will drop to him so how does he address the middling positional rank of his QBs (6th overall and per player)? Is a trade up on the cards?

Alex has a fairly extensive RB core – with CMC boosting its value to give second overall value. Could he add another young stud or look to bolster the rest of the roster?

Alex sacrificed a third round pick in 2021 (and a first in 2022) to improve his WR core. He'll be happy with his two starters who contribute to his 3rd overall rank. The rest of his core drags him down to 5th so will this be an area where Alex may seek some long-term improvement?

Alex has a small but very solid TE core. Ranked at 6 due to the injury to Jarwin (and to some extent Dak) but third per player because of Kittle he could be safe here. Injury risk is very high and if Pitts makes it to 8 will he make this the overall no. 1 TE core?



IX. Pick #9 – Team SquirrelGman – Gareth

Total						Starters		Draft Capital			
Ave Age	Rank	Value	Rank	Value (No DC)	Rank	Value	Rank	Value	Rank		
28.11	10	93,126	7	82,404	5	47,676	9	10,722	7		
QB						RB					
No.	Ave age	Value	Rank	Value PP	Rank PP	No.	Ave age	Value	Rank	Value PP	Rank PP
4	31.59	19,531	4	4,883	5	8	23.36	22,497	5	2,812	9
WR						TE					
No.	Ave age	Value	Rank	Value PP	Rank PP	No.	Ave age	Value	Rank	Value PP	Rank PP
9	27.47	30,311	6	3,368	10	2	28.18	10,045	3	5,023	1

Will I mention that Gareth is by far the oldest GM in our league or that he picked a broken QB ahead of a top 5 pick? With a team name as bad as that – no! If there was a team in need of an investment in youth, it's this one. I suppose on the plus side none of his players are as old as he is.

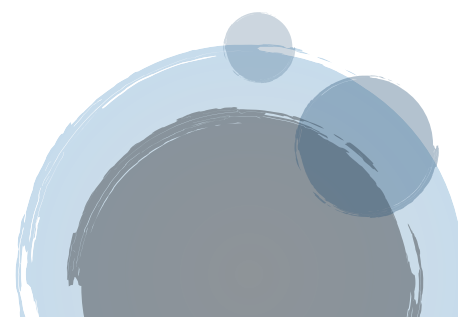
It's genuinely difficult to say whether Gareth's investment in older players has and will pay off or not. He made it to the championship game with this team after-all but his team ranking is somewhat lacking. An overall team value rank of 7, slightly increasing to 5 without the draft capital suggests it may not be paying off. This view could be exacerbated by his starter rank of 9! He doesn't even appear to have a great deal of high production studs to point to that it is a low value, high production team. With such low picks this year, does he also need to consider starting a rebuild?

Gareth probably doesn't have a high enough pick to select an QB in the draft without a significant trade up. He may not need to though. He has a better than average rank of 4 here but, surprise surprise, the age of his core may be a long-term concern that needs addressing.

In stark contrast to the rest of his team, RB is the one position which has youth on its side. However, with a rank of 5 overall and 9 per player, it may be youthful but perhaps lacking in quality. If one of those young RBs makes it to him he has an opportunity to continue the one place he invests in youth.

WR looks like an area where Gareth may unsurprisingly need to seek some long-term improvement. His aging core has low dynasty value but some potential high production. He too could probably wait until 2022 to improve this area of his team but if a young stud drops to him here are the G&Ts about to come out?

Whilst not blessed with youth his TE core does have real quality in Waller. Only injury is likely to be a concern for this area of his team, for now.



X. Pick #10 – Team Rossmatt1982 – Ross

Total						Starters		Draft Capital			
Ave Age	Rank	Value	Rank	Value (No DC)	Rank	Value	Rank	Value	Rank		
24.27	2	93,528	6	81,232	7	59,382	1	12,296	6		
QB						RB					
No.	Ave age	Value	Rank	Value PP	Rank PP	No.	Ave age	Value	Rank	Value PP	Rank PP
2	24.07	19,448	5	9,724	1	5	24.01	23,211	4	4,642	1
WR						TE					
No.	Ave age	Value	Rank	Value PP	Rank PP	No.	Ave age	Value	Rank	Value PP	Rank PP
5	24.61	25,587	10	5,117	1	5	24.72	12,986	2	2,597	8

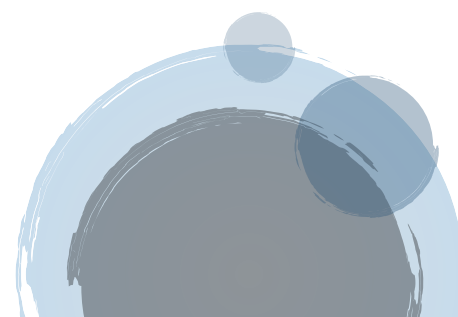
So will I be as generous and kind to our belt holder as I was in the last review? Even though his team name is merely a reflection of his name and youthful age – reluctantly yes. His overall rank is in some way misleading. Ranked at 6 overall and 7th without his additional draft capital it would suggest that he's in no position to compete. However, he has a starter rank of 1. The reason for this, a potential Achilles heel. A much smaller team, susceptible to injury, combined with an over-confidence in rookies. His rookie picks could once again go straight into his roster, negating the taxi, but will he have the same luck as the last draft, particularly picking from 10? Time will tell.

Ross' most obvious deficiency comes at QB. Not in starters – a player value average of a staggering 9,700 makes him the clear number one in QBs. The problem, he only has 2, in a superflex league. A big trade up will be needed to snatch yet another stud rookie. He has the players to trade but not the depth to cover. A conundrum we will all be intrigued to see resolved.

With just 5 RBs his core is small but valuable with another number 1 per player rank. He may need to draft here just to get some warm bodies on roster.

A very similar story at WR. While every other team has at least 7 WRs, most with 8 or more, Ross has just 5. In a position known for its inconsistency, drafting in this area could be a must. Saying that, once again he has value on his side with the top per player value at the position.

In stark contrast to the rest of his team building he has a relative plethora of TEs. This gives him top two value. Unfortunately for him, this comes at the cost of quality. If he wants to win again trading up for Pitts could secure him another victory and retaining that coveted belt.



XI. Pick #26 – Team ChrisNewbrook – Chris

Total						Starters		Draft Capital			
Ave Age	Rank	Value	Rank	Value (No DC)	Rank	Value	Rank	Value	Rank		
25.52	3	82,899	9	80,068	8	51,064	5	2,831	9		
QB						RB					
No.	Ave age	Value	Rank	Value PP	Rank PP	No.	Ave age	Value	Rank	Value PP	Rank PP
3	25.01	16,310	7	5,437	3	6	25.47	21,022	8	3,504	7
WR						TE					
No.	Ave age	Value	Rank	Value PP	Rank PP	No.	Ave age	Value	Rank	Value PP	Rank PP
10	26.08	36,122	4	3,612	8	3	23.33	6,614	8	2,205	9

Will I apologise for constantly implying that Chris picked an aging, win-now team all of last season? Unless he changes that appalling team name I shall certainly not!

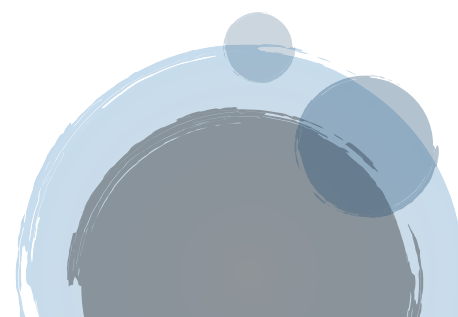
It would appear that the age of Chris' team was somewhat exaggerated. Whilst not the youngest it does certainly have a youthful flourish. But probably the real question is – is it any good? An overall team value rank of 9, rising slightly to 8 once draft capital is removed would suggest it isn't. It gets slightly better when we consider the starters with a rank of 5. This includes the value of a player who is unlikely to feature in any NFL team in 2021 but could be playing in orange in a Texan penitentiary. *"But noble Commissioner, is it not a low value, high production team?"* It is youth that generally provides high value. If the team is young and has low value what does that tell us? Let's take a closer look.

Chris' team ostensibly has a small number of quality QBs with strength in its relative youth – ranked 3rd per player. However, the aforementioned Texan, combined with a QB who is not predicted to be on the field until game 4-6 means it will be a difficult season at QB without considerable strengthening. Not drafting until pick 26 means a dramatic trade up will be required to pick up a starting QB in the draft.

A healthy sized RB core is only ranked 8th with a per player value boosted by Cook putting it at 7. An injection of youth and quality here is a must.

In direct contrast to Ross, Chris has a large WR core ranking in at 4. With such a large core the value is not to be found, ranking at 8th on a per player basis. Again, an injection of youth and quality should be the long-term aim.

Despite having Gronk on his roster, Chris' TE core is one of the most youthful. However, ranking at 8th overall and 9th per player he will be hoping for a breakout season for one of his young guns.



XII. Pick #37 – Jurassic Chark-less – Jebus

Total						Starters		Draft Capital			
Ave Age	Rank	Value	Rank	Value (No DC)	Rank	Value	Rank	Value	Rank		
26.43	8	95,426	5	94,936	3	53,018	4	490	10		
QB						RB					
No.	Ave age	Value	Rank	Value PP	Rank PP	No.	Ave age	Value	Rank	Value PP	Rank PP
6	27.66	21,484	3	3,581	8	5	25.45	22,303	6	4,461	2
WR						TE					
No.	Ave age	Value	Rank	Value PP	Rank PP	No.	Ave age	Value	Rank	Value PP	Rank PP
9	26.7	41,748	1	4,639	3	3	25.33	9,401	5	3,134	5

Finally another team which actually has a name. Sadly a preview of the upcoming draft seems rather perfunctory as to all intents and purposes Jebus won't really be taking part in the draft unless there is some dramatic trading.

Trading a 24 year old for a 43 and 30 year old have not done Jebus' average age any favours. Trading his draft away he would probably like to think he's competing this year but what do the rankings tell us? Ranked 5 in overall value, unsurprisingly improved by removing draft capital from the equation, suggests he's middle of the pack. Taking starters into account does improve his ranking slightly. Perhaps it a low value, high production team. Let's see if our Commissioner is delusional.

An astonishing 6 QBs puts the overall rank at 3rd but when we look on a per player basis the rank falls to 8. Does Jebus really think he can compete with Tom Brady and Daniel Jones as his QB2s? With little hope of drafting a QB – the delusion must be real.

A smaller RB core ranks in at 6th but on a per player basis, Saquon and The Yeti boost the rank to 2. A long-term injection of youth and quality here is a must.

Another large WR core has Jebus' WRers ranked 1st overall. Even on a per player basis this only falls to 3rd so there is some quality in depth here. However, an injection of youth has to be long-term aim with an average age of nearly 27.

Jebus' TE core is relatively youthful but only ranked 5th overall and per player. If he really wants to win, some differential improvement here is badly needed. Is a miraculous trade up for Pitts even possible?

XIII. Conclusion

Have I been too harsh? Not harsh enough? If my assessments are to be believed nobody is really competing to win or perhaps we just have a competitive league with no one dominant team? That may be a good thing, I think. Anyway, I'm very much looking forward to the NFL Draft and then our first rookie draft, even though I'll largely be an observer. I hope I have inspired some contemplations of rosters which will result in some great trading before, on and after the 14th May. See you all in 2 weeks.